

# Zach Zukowski

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## AI-AUGMENTED RESEARCH · GOVERNANCE INFRASTRUCTURE · TOKENIZATION

14 custom MCP servers · ~75 DATs analyzed · diligence-doc review shortened from 4hr to 1hr per deal · 8 SSRN papers

### SUMMARY

AI-augmented research and governance infrastructure strategist. Built 14 custom Python MCP servers (FRED macro data, DefiLlama / CoinGecko / Artemis stablecoin and DeFi data, Helius for Solana, Etherscan / Blockscout for EVM chains, rated.network / Beaconcha.in for validator data, Tally for DAO governance, Dune Analytics, Spacescope, Nansen for wallet flows, and GitHub for specs and code) plus AI-assisted diligence workflows reducing subscription-document review ~4x (4 hours to 1 hour per deal) and automated SEC-filing and press-release monitoring covering ~75 Digital Asset Treasury Stocks (DATs) in 2025. Founding research hire at Borderless Capital (RIA, Dec 2019 to Feb 2026); shipped 250 portfolio investments at ~\$500M AUM; predicted Thorchain's \$200M insolvency 13 months ahead; sourced the LayerZero seed (~80x). Now founder of Tokenization Systems (Feb 2026 to present); published eight SSRN papers including Governance Concentration Beyond Token Allocation (40-protocol cross-section; protocol sector predicts governance concentration more than initial token allocation; Cohen's d = 0.96 between DePIN and DeFi) and Operational Risk in Token Economies.

### EXPERIENCE

#### Founder · Tokenization Systems

Feb 2026 – Present

- Authored an eight-paper SSRN-live research program covering the [Control Layer Intensity Index](#) (CLII) for gateway concentration, the [Minimum Viable Equivalence Pack](#) (MVEP) for institutional tokenization diligence, programmable monetary-policy design ([Adaptive Tokenomics](#)), [governance concentration](#), and [operational risk in token economies](#).
- Contributed eight comment letters across a federal regulatory program (OCC bank stablecoin engagement [RIN 1557-AF41](#) plus [supplemental control-layer extension](#); Treasury GENIUS Act state similarity; FDIC payment-stablecoin reserve standards [RIN 3064-AG19](#) and stablecoin-subsidiary issuance approvals [RIN 3064-AG20](#); FinCEN AML/CFT [FINCEN-2026-0034](#); FinCEN-OFAC PPSI sanctions [FINCEN-2026-0100](#); joint banking AML/CFT [91 FR 18304](#); [Routing the Dollar](#) submitted to the Federal Reserve Fifth Conference on the Dollar's International Roles (Jun 2026); [Governance Concentration](#) in peer review at Frontiers in Blockchain.
- Working dialogue with capital-markets infrastructure operators on stablecoin, deposit-token, tokenized-deposit, and tokenized-equity deployment.

#### Senior Investment Analyst, Digital Assets · Borderless Capital (RIA; first hire)

Dec 2019 – Feb 2026

- Built automated SEC-filing and press-release monitoring for Digital Asset Treasury Stocks (DATs); analyzed ~75 tokenization offerings in 2025 and invested in 18; AI-assisted diligence workflows reducing subscription-document review from ~4 hours to ~1 hour per deal.
- Built quantitative token-economic models forecasting emissions, fee capture, subsidy-to-revenue trajectories, and governance concentration under wide scenario ranges; supply-equilibrium and slashing dynamics supporting Layer 1 mechanism-design advisory.
- Predicted Thorchain's **\$200M insolvency 13 months in advance**; Borderless held no exposure when the predicted failure mode materialized.
- Sourced the **LayerZero seed round** investment for Borderless, returning ~80x; the underlying cross-chain interoperability thesis preceded the firm's Cross-Chain Ecosystem Fund by two years.
- Advised 100 portfolio companies 1-on-1 on token mechanism design (stablecoin reserves, governance-token allocation and incentive design, yield wrappers, burn/emission dynamics); standards defined in [Introduction to Tokenomics](#).
- Mapped jurisdictional tax / regulatory advantages of DAT structures over direct crypto holding: Japan's Metaplanet DAT cuts crypto capital-gains tax from up to 55% to 20% (equity rate, further reducible via Japan's IRA structure); Hong Kong's Southbound Connect could give mainland Chinese capital regulated access to crypto banned domestically.
- Translated regulatory change (GENIUS, CLARITY, Singapore MAS, MiCA, state money-transmitter and trust-charter regimes) into product, reserve, routing, and compliance decisions across U.S., Singapore, Cayman / BVI / Bermuda, and EU; coordinated cross-functional partner work spanning Product / Engineering, Risk (operational-risk taxonomy), and Legal.
- Led discovery and diligence across a 1,000+ deal investment funnel (pre-seed to Series C); shipped 250 portfolio investments at ~25% deployment rate across ~10 institutional funds (~\$500M AUM), with build/partner/hold recommendations to committee.
- Built the firm's research function from scratch; led a four-analyst team producing ~25 long-form publications annually; taught 100 teams across nine accelerator programs (2021 to 2025).

## SELECTED RESEARCH

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- [Governance Concentration Beyond Token Allocation](#). In peer review at Frontiers in Blockchain. 40-protocol cross-section: initial token allocation does not predict governance concentration; protocol sector does (DePIN significantly more concentrated than DeFi; Cohen's  $d = 0.96$ ).
- [Operational Risk in Token Economies](#). Operational-risk taxonomy (74 risk vectors, 64 testable controls, 31 program objectives) mapped to a 624-scenario battery; Lido V3 staking-vault case study.
- [Adaptive Tokenomics](#). Industrial control engineering (PID controller) applied to token-supply emission as programmable monetary-policy mechanism; 240-scenario Monte Carlo simulation; cuts worst-case supply volatility ~6x under competitor-shock attack.
- [Who Burns the Tokens?](#) Burn-mechanism design (carrier contracts vs. subscriptions) drives demand concentration: Helium's carrier-contract model concentrates ~90% of token burns in 5 purchasers (HHI 0.22) despite ~1M hotspots; coalition-power analysis extends standard concentration measures for single-address risk.
- [Routing the Dollar](#). Submitted to Federal Reserve / FRBNY Fifth Conference on the Dollar's International Roles (Jun 2026). Gateway concentration; CLII across 19 gateways including Visa Direct-adjacent paths.
- [Minimum Viable Equivalence Pack](#). Ten-category institutional diligence standard; finds bank-chartered stablecoin issuers face ~22x the regulatory capital requirements of money-transmitter-chartered issuers at \$40B scale.
- [Three Tokenization Strategies](#). Each of three strategies satisfies different MVEP categories with measurably different strength (Regulated Collateral Circuit, Multi-Issuer Yield Stack, Tokenized Equity Rails); Securitize as cross-strategy concentration risk.
- [Seven Dollars](#). Cross-product framework for major dollar-denominated digital products; CLII / MVEP decoupling; stress propagation through dependency chains (SVB, Circle pool, Paxos).

## TECHNICAL

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**Methods:** policy-shock impact estimation (difference-in-differences), Monte Carlo simulation, PID controller design (industrial control engineering), coalition-power analysis, supply equilibrium modeling, build-versus-partner framework design

**Data:** Dune Analytics, Nansen Pro, Artemis, DefiLlama, CoinGecko, Helius (Solana), Etherscan, Blockscout (EVM), Spacescope, Token Terminal, Tally (DAO governance), rated.network, Beaconcha.in (validator data), FRED (macro); automated SEC filing and press release monitoring

**Stack:** Python (pandas, statsmodels, scipy, matplotlib), R (fixest, did, synthdid), SQL (DuneSQL, Trino), JavaScript / TypeScript; 14 custom Python MCP servers wrapping the data sources above plus GitHub; Claude.ai + Claude Code + Cursor with 36-skill library and 17-file living-knowledge architecture; n8n, Apify, Git / GitHub

## RECOGNITION

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- Uniswap Foundation governance committee (2024)
- ETHDenver pitch judge
- [Introduction to Tokenomics](#) article publicly endorsed by Binance founder CZ on day of publication

## EDUCATION

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**High Point University** | B.S.B.A., Business Administration (Magna Cum Laude) · Investment Club President  
Lingnan University, Hong Kong (Exchange)

2018